

Week 3 English Language Notes

TOPIC: PHRASES

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Class: SS 1 A and B

ENGLISH LANGUAGE (SS1)

TOPIC: PHRASES

(Definition, Types, and Differences Between Phrases and Clauses)

1. DEFINITION OF A PHRASE

A **phrase** is a **group of related words** that work together **but do not contain a finite verb** and **do not express a complete thought**.

- ◆ A phrase can act as a **noun, verb, adjective, or adverb** in a sentence.
- ◆ A phrase **cannot stand alone** as a sentence.

Examples:

- *in the morning*
 - *a bunch of keys*
 - *very happy*
 - *has been working*
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2. TYPES OF PHRASES

There are **five main types of phrases** commonly taught at SS1 level.

A. NOUN PHRASE (NP)

A **noun phrase** has a **noun or pronoun as its headword** and may include modifiers such as adjectives, determiners, or prepositional phrases.

Structure:

Determiner + Adjective(s) + Noun

Examples:

- *the tall boy*
- *my new school bag*
- *a basket of mangoes*

In a sentence:

👉 *The tall boy won the race.*

B. VERB PHRASE (VP)

A **verb phrase** consists of a **main verb** and its **auxiliary (helping) verbs**.

Examples:

- *is running*
- *has eaten*
- *will be going*

In a sentence:

👉 *She has finished her homework.*

C. ADJECTIVE PHRASE (AdjP)

An **adjective phrase** describes a noun and may include adverbs that modify the adjective.

Examples:

- *very intelligent*
- *extremely tall*
- *full of joy*

In a sentence:

👉 *She is very intelligent.*

D. ADVERBIAL PHRASE (AdvP)

An **adverbial phrase** modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb. It tells **how, when, where, or to what extent**.

Examples:

- *very quickly*
- *quite early*
- *too slowly*

In a sentence:

👉 He ran *very quickly*.

E. PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE (PP)

A **prepositional phrase** begins with a **preposition** and ends with an **object (noun or pronoun)**.

Structure:

Preposition + Object

Examples:

- *in the classroom*
- *under the table*
- *beside the road*

In a sentence:

👉 The book is *on the desk*.

3. FUNCTIONS OF PHRASES IN SENTENCES

A phrase can function as:

- **Subject** – *The little boy* is crying.
 - **Object** – She bought *a new dress*.
 - **Complement** – He is *very tired*.
 - **Modifier** – The boy *with the cap* is my friend.
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4. DIFFERENCES BETWEEN PHRASES AND CLAUSES

Feature	Phrase	Clause
Contains a subject	✗ No	☑ Yes

Feature	Phrase	Clause
Contains a finite verb	✗ No	✓ Yes
Expresses complete meaning	✗ No	Sometimes
Can stand alone as a sentence	✗ No	✓ (if independent)
Example	<i>in the house when he arrived</i>	

5. WHAT IS A CLAUSE? (For Comparison)

A **clause** is a group of words that contains **both a subject and a finite verb**.

Examples:

- *She is reading.*
 - *because he was late*
 - *when the bell rang*
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6. PHRASE vs CLAUSE (EXAMPLES)

Phrase	Clause
<i>after the match</i>	<i>after the match ended</i>
<i>a beautiful girl</i>	<i>the girl is beautiful</i>
<i>in the classroom</i>	<i>they are in the classroom</i>

7. SUMMARY

- A **phrase** is a group of words **without a finite verb**.
 - A **clause** has a **subject and a finite verb**.
 - Phrases help to **add meaning and detail** to sentences.
 - Common phrase types include **noun, verb, adjective, adverbial, and prepositional phrases**.
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8. EVALUATION / CLASS EXERCISE

1. Identify the type of phrase in each sentence:
 - a. She wore *a beautiful dress*.
 - b. The boys ran *very fast*.
 - c. The cat is *under the table*.
 2. State whether the underlined group of words is a **phrase** or a **clause**:
 - a. *when the rain stopped*
 - b. *in the evening*
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